Ajahn Sumedho - 108 Talks by Ajahn Sumedho - Fear

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SUMMARY KEYWORDS

identify, doubt, fear, awareness, present moment, acceptance, thoughts, arises, meditation, act, devotion, changing, justifications, exploitation, means, boredom, opinion, concepts, mindfulness, accept

SPEAKERS

Ajahn Sumedho

Ajahn Sumedho 00:00
Dealing with the hindrances that arise in our meditation, fear and doubt, probably the most difficult to deal with.

Ajahn Sumedho 00:18
And once you can see clearly the characteristics of fear and doubt and no longer identify with them then of course, you know the impact that you know you become aware of the Middle Way fear is something that people

00:50
generally tend to

Ajahn Sumedho 00:52
try to get away from MIT it arises from not knowing, not understanding. And from identifying with all kinds of memories and perceptions, images and thoughts

Ajahn Sumedho 01:18
so, we become aware of the present moment of fear as it arises and falls, doubt all these rather nebulous things. We're afraid of something directly like a mannequin Tiger is attacking. That's one kind of fear, but then the fear that kind of nameless state of anxiety, terror it seems groundless. So there's no definite thing in mind. We don't we just don't know what will happen. What will happen when we die or what will happen tomorrow. We're afraid that there's something that we are something that we don't think we should be. I mean, someday, some disaster catastrophe is going to overwhelm us. Or that there's all kinds of horrible fearful things lurking inside us that will come out at the inappropriate times and other wellness.

Ajahn Sumedho 02:30

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But as we practice, we become aware that those are only conceptions,

02:37
views, opinions, memories, imaginings.

Ajahn Sumedho 02:46
Because we bring awareness always into the present moment. establish our from one moment to the next

02:58
constant,

Ajahn Sumedho 03:01
continuous awareness.

Ajahn Sumedho 03:09
So as long as we identify and conceive ourselves as being a person identified with our memory, concepts we have what we should or shouldn't be, and what we think we are will be hard, then we're always going to be limited by those concepts. And that limitation always leaves out

03:34
that feeling of joy,

Ajahn Sumedho 03:38
that freedom of having no self has not been any party.

Ajahn Sumedho 03:53
So when fear arises in in you, it's something to welcome rather than despise or fear. Feel aversion talk. If there's fear, doubt, doubt, not knowing for sure. doubt about who you are about what you should be doubt about your practice doubt about meditation and Buddhism, about the right technique or the right way. doubt about anything.

Ajahn Sumedho 04:36
That state of not knowing not being sure arises and passes away

Ajahn Sumedho 04:50
this weekend know when we watch, we have awareness we can see clearly the Present Moment whatever might be there or not there

Ajahn Sumedho 05:28
every single opinion and viewpoint that you have about yourself in the universe see as a nature to cannot rather than as reality

Ajahn Sumedho 05:48

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constant reflection on this within yourself these identities with fear with doubt, with anger with lost with stupidity how it causes a tremendous amount of anguish and despair in our lives in spend, some people spend their whole life in the state of depression. Why? How can I do that? Because they've never reflected they've never stopped and said who am I? In this present moment is this the reality this moving thought is doubt itself is disparagement self hatred, fear but as meditators we confront face look at welcome accept things as they are acceptance of Fear takes all the power out of fear. Fear only has power over us when we remain ignorant and react blindly to it. We give it power by creating it adding to it seasoning more thoughts more views more opinion

Ajahn Sumedho 07:17
when I say reflect or contemplate this means to stop and look at like one stands back

07:25
and looks at something

Ajahn Sumedho 07:32
like anger aversion when that arises

07:37
What did that do? What does it feel like? When you're angry?

Ajahn Sumedho 07:43
What does it do to your body during Have you really investigated? When you're bored? And you investigated bored and we know what boredom is? What does it do to you? restlessness. What does that feel like when you look at your body when you're feeling restless? Worried

08:06
anxious,

Ajahn Sumedho 08:09
soulful? Or do you just blind in doubt and react, repress.

08:16
Reject or follow

Ajahn Sumedho 08:24
stop that one who walks in the middle is always welcoming the teachers that are teaching you good everything is teaching you're not saying I only want these teachers and I don't want that. I only want the neurons to teach me I want all the good and why the pure I don't want any of the stupid and dirty ignorant kind of teachers this means you've taken sides with that which is pure and good against that which is stupid 30 So you'll find a certain kind of despair and sorrow and anguish entering your life because as more you cling to the floor and the good the more you'll feel threatened by its opposite but on the middle part midway down, make preferences you just observe and see identified with any of it, you know go into stuff and they'd be good Facebook wonderful find clean or visible, stupid, dirty, ugly

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boredom, restlessness fear and doubt sleeping dog lacks greed worry anxiety all these things be anything they're not mine they don't belong to me they just come in and they go

Ajahn Sumedho 10:35
I don't want them to come anymore you're again taking time I don't want those negative things in me I want them to go away that's another kind of desire. Desire does not have the things that you've got already. With the attitude of acceptance and one accept things and learn from moment to moment to moment learning from the highs and the low and the mean in the billion to find the refined the course. Because what do all these things teach? What are they teaching us are teaching us that simple truth of existence that all compounded things are impermanent. The unsatisfactory and they're not ours they're not meeting on my.

Ajahn Sumedho 12:01
With a practice of metta, loving kindness, this is a way of acceptance. Metta practice is always the acceptance of things as they are. So when we accept things as they are as we is the things come in go through a consciousness This is the metta practice also have seen them competency men girl

12:44
acceptance of them

Ajahn Sumedho 12:48
nothing I don't want you to go away or I want you I want to keep you lust or infatuation to grab hold of our goodness I'll refine when I say this I want to keep for me this is what I want to be I want to be like this is refined, wonderful, beautiful creature or the rejection I shouldn't be I shouldn't have said horrible thoughts I shouldn't have such rotten intonation. I must get rid of these horrible thoughts and things. But with the meta directed inward there comes equanimity acceptance, balance, cooling is the very attention observing the changing phenomena neither Gladys beauty nor miserable at it either.

Ajahn Sumedho 14:12
Can you any of you accept every single thought? Doubt fear, opinion and view memory just as it is

14:30
accepted, welcoming.

Ajahn Sumedho 14:33
Observe it is change rather than

14:36
picking, choosing, fidgeting,

Ajahn Sumedho 14:40
rushing around trying to make it go away or keep it wondering what is supposed to do next. Can you just patiently do or watching any things be as they are letting the universe be as it is? Now thinking or

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indulging in thinking about what how you should be or how the universe should be. Then you just walk down or lay down and let the universe be as it is. That means your own mind

Ajahn Sumedho 15:21
conditions that come and go. That takes awareness, to be able to do that mindfulness. As soon as we are heedless, and we start identifying with the changing phenomena. This identity means we cling, identify with hatred, identify with greed, identify with sleeping, we identify with pain, we identify with pleasure. We identify with love with hate.

Ajahn Sumedho 16:04
When we no longer identify with it that doesn't mean we're rejecting it just means we know its true nature. Beyond all the changing things, phenomena is that which is perfect complete, which we can never become but only be and may only be imperfect when we are aware. Because when there's awareness, then we're beyond all the myriad discriminations, differences that we have habitually for how many lifetimes identified we.

16:57
Talking about oneness

Ajahn Sumedho 17:02
with awareness, we don't see each other as this person not person. With awareness, there's no room for calling or conflict, or war, or persecution or exploitation with heedlessness. And that's identifying with the changing phenomena, all the compounded things that we perceive as there is an endless opportunity for conflict, confusion, lower quality,

17:35
enmity, hatred,

Ajahn Sumedho 17:38
exploitation.

Ajahn Sumedho 17:47
Essential consciousness is always seeing things from the senses and identifying with the senses, the objects of sense. For example, your eye here, this is my knees and my eyes, and what I see with my eyes some things I call a mind, I call it I say, The clothes I'm wearing, these are my clothes, my house, my car, my wife, my children, my cat, my dog, my radio.

Ajahn Sumedho 18:26
We identify with the sounds we hear, that the taste, smells, identify with physical pain or pleasure. We identify with desire, with boredom, with hatred, that defy with memories. Identify with our hopes and expectations, our ambition goes on and on always changing. But above that identification with changing phenomena when one stands outside looking at it, is there any difference between you and I?

Ajahn Sumedho 19:15

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Is there any room for conflict? Is there any room for quibbling for calling

19:22
for war,

Ajahn Sumedho 19:24
exploitation

Ajahn Sumedho 19:35
by being wise, it means being aware from one moment to the next. And this of course, is why we're here, practice of Buddhist meditation. Not sitting here too in order to attain something sitting here for an hour to attain Some kind of thing that we think we'd like to identify with just peace or tranquility but sitting here being wise the doubt what do you mean being wise I'm not wise to be yours yet before there's any wisdom in me hard work sitting for hours every day conquering all the kill aces

20:45
fighting Mara combating the devil for my evil tendencies.

Ajahn Sumedho 20:57
And you listen listen to all your doubts. By listening by acceptance, this is called being why

21:17
being wise

Ajahn Sumedho 21:21
trying to be wise, can you try to be wise? I'm going to sit here and try to be wise for now.

Ajahn Sumedho 21:37
So you preconceived wisdom and yourself and try to get all mucked up the difference between being and trying to be trying to be the conception trying to be mindful, I shall try to be mindful for the next five minutes. You created five minutes as a conception and mindfulness and try you've created a whole series of things that you identify with and hope and expect.

Ajahn Sumedho 22:25
There without conceiving mindfulness, or five minutes time, the space or whatever be what is the moment right now? Do you know who you are? You know what's going on what's going through your consciousness or you're trying to find something. There's something there that should be going on. Or you try doubting and wondering, I wonder what is going on right now? Should it be this or should it be that

23:09
I don't know what it means.

Ajahn Sumedho 23:12

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It's also confusing.

Ajahn Sumedho 23:57
One of the biggest obstacles to meditation is having a concept about meditation.

24:04
Making a preference

Ajahn Sumedho 24:10
doubting wondering if you're doing it right? How long it will take before you advise having an opinion that there's something you should do before you do something else. So by being wise, you just watch a lot taller to have those opinions and views. concepts don't think that you shouldn't have which is now their natural nature. see things as they are in the present moment in nature to Canada

Ajahn Sumedho 25:09
Also I want to

25:13
suggest that people come in here.

Ajahn Sumedho 25:18
It's nice, on occasion to bring candle, candles, incense and flowers is offering. And this is a tradition, ceremony. And thing that is good to do to make an offering. As part of our devotional practices in Buddhism is using our bodies and using our conventions. It's an act of devotion, of worship, of say, of gratitude, of love to the teacher, the Buddha, the one who knows the wise one, the wise one is in me, that's another concept

Ajahn Sumedho 26:06
that's a beautiful beautiful behavior. So, harmonious living, we learn to use the body in a harmonious and beautiful way and graceful action, generous movement. Giving is one way I come to this higher to get something rather say I come to the Bihar to give

Ajahn Sumedho 26:45
actually physically give something

Ajahn Sumedho 26:53
Bali This is another putting one head down 30 How to bow mindfully of surrendering oneself physically and giving oneself in the in the act of bowing and say saying I'm not aggressive. I'm not here to get anything. I'm here to listen. I'm open shut off or close I'm proud

Ajahn Sumedho 27:40
get proud of that you're bound so well. Have you thought hating people who don't bow and this is an act of devotion. Devotion is opening of the heart the emotion not intellectual and what is the what are they? How many how much do I gain from bowing? You can try to figure out its advantages or disadvantages

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and whether it's the real downloads necessary or unnecessary. Any opinion interview that you have is just another opinion interview is something that is done or not done.

28:45
Giving or not giving the heedlessness there's

Ajahn Sumedho 28:57
always this rationalization justification this wanting to criticize analyze or find reasons for doing or not doing something. But in our lives if we live our lives in wisdom Then we do or not do.

Ajahn Sumedho 29:23
With awareness we know what to do the generous the beautiful loci and the things we act on. Impulses

29:32
spontaneous good actions

Ajahn Sumedho 29:39
are done through awareness to see an understanding Time and Place

Ajahn Sumedho 29:53
awareness of not doing wrong impulses selfish impulses Evil impulses. We do not act on we do not act with physical action or speech

30:13
things that cause

Ajahn Sumedho 30:14
harm, we cause pain insensitive things that hurt how sales are the beans around

Ajahn Sumedho 30:27
chanting What? Is this a valuable thing? Or is it useless? Or is it something one should do I want you to do you have a doubt about it. Do it

30:51
don't do it.

Ajahn Sumedho 30:54
What is what goes on? Do you know? If to find reasons or justifications? Do you have to be convinced? Do you have to be forced to taking a stand and saying I'm not going to do it? Or I'm going to do it

Ajahn Sumedho 31:15
people always say oh chanting is reminds me of my Christian background and all those awful things that the Roman Catholics used to do to me. Dry devotion and rites and rituals and ceremonies. This is taking this time

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31:35
can you

Ajahn Sumedho 31:37
mindfully participate in the ceremony? Or are you going to reject it because you're taking a stand against it?

Ajahn Sumedho 31:50
Can you give yourself to a ceremony to a tradition? Are you going to fail only go so far and stop

Ajahn Sumedho 32:05
like the monastic life can you give yourself to the monastic life while there's going to be reservations? I'll go so far and then I and I don't know

Ajahn Sumedho 32:22
meditation I'll go so far and then maybe

Ajahn Sumedho 32:32
I want life on my terms and always with the bridges there so I can run back cross them if I don't like what the hell is me. This is a coaster samsara aimless wandering but in the practice of my awareness mindfulness is always the present moment to complete involvement complete surrender accepted

Ajahn Sumedho 33:06
and that's the Gration freedom. The other where the doubt the rationalizations justifications reservations game then there's always a myriad complexity we are going to call this way that way.

33:26
confuse us

Ajahn Sumedho 33:36
also this for your reflection

Ajahn Sumedho 33:50
Saturday

33:53
will be in Birmingham, then Ebola

Ajahn Sumedho 33:58
rabid Adamas center is that we know our waste festival

Ajahn Sumedho 34:09
Jerry Undergaro and Joe will be here too.

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Ajahn Sumedho 34:47
Tiger numbers your property finder

34:58
there

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